

transportation from the mill to the ultimate users is borne by the Government. The yarn supply under this scheme has risen to 678 lakh kgs. in 2007-08 from 220 lakhs kgs. in 2005-06. The number of Yarn Depots has also increased from 110 to 485.

Financial turn around of Apex Societies

Apex Societies like Cooptex (Tamil Nadu), APCO (Andhra Pradesh), KHDC (Karnataka), Boyanica (Orissa) have all started making profits after years of losses after receiving assistance under a restructuring plan. In all Rs.67.34 crores were disbursed to them and 3.63 lakh weavers have benefited.

Handloom Census The work on the Handloom Census has been entrusted to the National Council of Applied Economic Research (NCAER). This Census carried out once in 10 years is expected to be completed by the end of next year and will help in fine tuning the schemes to meet the felt need of weavers.

Under Marketing and Export Promotion Scheme (MEPS), the numbers of National, Special and District Level Exhibitions has drastically increased from just 184 events in the year 2004-05 to over 300 events every year now. This has tremendously helped in marketing the handloom fabrics all over the country.

Indian Institute of Handloom Technology (IIHT), Bargarh (Orissa) was commissioned in July, 2008. This is in addition to the four IIHTs already functioning at Varanasi, Salem,

Jodhpur and Guwahati. In addition, 25 Weavers' Service Centres (WSC) are providing institutional support through better designs and weaving processes.

Turn over of National Handloom Development Corporation (NHDC) which was Rs.253 crores in 2005-06 has increased to Rs.588 crores in 2007-08 and is expected to touch Rs.800 crores in 2008-09. This Corporation has been making profits for over a decade and assists weavers by supplying yarn and organizing exhibitions etc.

The Handloom Sector remains one of the key focus areas of the Government of India and due care has been taken in conceptualizing and implementing schemes which directly help the weavers to augment their earnings.

Increase in handloom fabric production over the years

